

Μητρόδωρος ὁ Χῖος

Metrodorus of Chios on Nature and Knowledge

eul_aid: dmk

Period: [Κλασική](#) [Classical](#)
Dialect: [Φιλοσοφική Ἀττική](#) [Attic](#) [Philosophical](#)
Domain: [Φιλοσοφία](#) [Philosophy](#)
Format: [Συναγωγή](#) [Collection](#)
Affiliation: [Atomist](#)

Metrodorus of Chios was a Greek philosopher who lived during the 4th century BCE. A native of the island of Chios, he studied under the atomist thinker Democritus and is recorded as having taught Anaxarchus, who would later influence skeptical philosophy.

Metrodorus wrote several works, but they survive only in fragments quoted by later authors. His writings included a major treatise **On Nature**, which explored atomist physics, and a now-lost **Trojan History**, showing his interest beyond pure philosophy.

His historical importance lies in his role as a bridge between earlier atomism and later philosophical movements. He extended the ideas of Democritus, proposing, for example, that there are countless worlds in different stages of existence. More strikingly, he expressed radical doubt about the possibility of knowledge. A famous opening statement attributed to him questioned whether we can know anything at all—even whether knowing is possible. This extreme skepticism positions him as a significant forerunner to the later traditions of philosophical skepticism.

Works (3)

- [Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Τρωικῶν Μύθων](#) · [Fragments on Trojan Legends](#) · 5 passages
- [Ἀποσπάσματα](#) · [On Nature and Knowledge](#) · 27 passages
- [Μαρτυρίαι](#) · [Testimonies](#) · 26 passages

Other Atomist Authors

- [Λεύκιππος ὁ Ἀτομιστής](#) · [Leucippus the Atomist](#) · 2 works